PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota Land Cruiser Prado 150

2009–2023 · J150 · KDJ150 · GDJ150 · TRJ150

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Which diesel, and what's been done**
  A 1KD-FTV (2009–2015) needs its timing belt at 150,000 km, and Unsealed 4X4 recommends servicing the injectors every 100,000 km. Listen for a cold-start knock or rattle and look for black smoke, which can mean the injectors are going. A 1GD-FTV (2015-on) has a chain but a DPF. Paperwork matters more than the odometer.
- [ ] **DPF history on 2015–2020 diesels**
  Ask whether the truck has the manual DPF regeneration switch (standard from June 2018) and the free 2020 exhaust hardware and software fix. Heavy white smoke, a foul smell, limp mode or rising fuel use point to a filter that isn't regenerating. A truck used only for short city trips is the riskiest.
- [ ] **Dust in the 2.8's intake**
  Unsealed 4X4 says the 1GD's airbox seal can let fine dust past the filter and coat the MAF sensor, which puts the truck in limp mode. Pull the filter and look for dust on the clean side.
- [ ] **Early brakes**
  Unsealed 4X4 reports that pre-2012 trucks could get a spongy or very hard pedal with a hiss from the booster. Toyota revised the booster and master cylinder, and the common fix is to fit the later parts.
- [ ] **Suspension bushes and rear air**
  Lower shock bushes and lower control-arm bushes wear, especially if aftermarket suspension was tightened with the truck hanging on a hoist. Kakadu rear air springs leak with age. Auto Buyers Guide says factory shocks are often tired by 100,000 km.
- [ ] **Tailgate and dash**
  The tailgate-mounted spare can make the door sag, so open and close it. Auto Buyers Guide also reports cracked dash tops on early trucks that lived in the sun.
- [ ] **2009 and 2017 electronics**
  Unsealed 4X4 flags the launch year and the 2017 facelift year for electrical gremlins, including airbag recalls on 2009 trucks and head-unit, ESC-light and shift complaints on 2017s. Look for evidence that they've been sorted.
- [ ] **Underbody and towing life**
  Check sills, bash plates and chassis rails for off-road damage and coastal rust, and ask what it has towed. Many 150s have pulled caravans at or near their 2,500–3,000 kg limit for years.

YEARS TO KNOW

2009	BEWARE	Unsealed 4X4 flags launch-year trucks for airbag recalls and electrical gremlins
2013	SWEET SPOT	First facelift (Japan 10 Sept, Australia October): new grille, bumpers and lamps, LED low beams, retuned suspension, five-mode MTS. Three-door dropped in Australia. Unsealed 4X4 calls 2013–15 a sweet spot for many buyers: past the early faults and before the DPF

2015–2020	BEWARE	Diesels sold October 2015 to April 2020 covered by the Australian DPF class action
2017	BEWARE	Second facelift on 12 September. V6 dropped in Australia. Unsealed 4X4 flags 2017 trucks for head-unit, ESC-light and shift glitches and says not to buy one without paperwork showing they've been fixed
2020	SWEET SPOT	August update: 150 kW / 500 Nm, 3,000 kg braked towing, auto only, 9-inch screen with CarPlay and Android Auto. Unsealed 4X4 calls 2020–on trucks the most desirable, and 4X4 Australia says this update finally resolved the DPF problem

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Model codes**
  KDJ150/155 = 1KD-FTV 3.0 diesel. GDJ150 = 1GD-FTV 2.8 diesel. TRJ150/152 = 2TR-FE 2.7 petrol. GRJ150 = 1GR-FE 4.0 V6. GRJ152 = 3.5 V6 (China). URJ150 = Lexus GX 460. A 155 suffix is the short three-door.
- ☐ **Market names**
  In the UK the J150 was sold as the Land Cruiser LC3, LC4 and LC5 by equipment level. Australian grades were GX, GXL, Altitude (from 2012), VX and Kakadu, plus the three-door SX and ZR until 2013.
- ☐ **Facelift tells**
  2013-on trucks have the larger grille and new lamps. 2017-on trucks have the second face with the vertical-bar grille. 2020-on Australian trucks have the 9-inch CarPlay screen.
- ☐ **DPF countermeasures**
  On a 2015–2020 diesel, look for the manual DPF regeneration switch (standard from June 2018) and ask a Toyota dealer whether the 2020 remedy is recorded against the VIN.
- ☐ **Spare and sub-tank**
  Trucks with the spare on the tailgate keep the 63-litre sub-tank. Under-floor spare versions give it up.

NOTES

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